

Iteration 1 – Common Documentation Pitfalls

Read Carefully

Iteration 1 is the foundation of your entire project. Most major project issues originate here. The following mistakes are the most common reasons teams lose points in Iteration 1.

1. Jumping to Implementation Without Solid Analysis

What we often see

- UI sketches or screenshots, but unclear requirements
- Classes or code discussed before use cases are complete
- “We plan to implement . . .” without explaining why

Why this fails

- Iteration 1 is analysis-first, not implementation-first
- Weak analysis leads to redesign later (and lost time)

How to avoid

- Finish requirements and use cases before discussing classes
- Ensure every planned feature appears in at least one use case

2. Use Cases That Are Just UI Click Steps

What we often see

- “User clicks button → system shows page”
- No business rules, no alternatives, no constraints

Why this fails

- Use cases describe system behavior, not UI navigation
- UI details change; system responsibilities should not

How to avoid

- Focus on what the system guarantees

3. Missing or Weak System Boundary

What we often see

- Actors doing system work
- External systems treated as internal components
- No clear distinction between user and system responsibility

Why this fails

- System boundary defines what you are responsible for building
- Unclear boundaries cause inconsistent diagrams and scope creep

How to avoid

- Explicitly define actors and system scope

4. Domain Model that Looks Like a Class Diagram

What we often see

- Methods, data types, or technical classes in the domain model
- UI or database concepts mixed in

Why this fails

- Domain models represent business concepts, not implementation
- Premature design hides real domain complexity

How to avoid

- Use nouns from the problem statement
- No methods, no UI classes, no persistence details

5. Treating Iteration 1 as “Draft” Documentation

What we often see

- Placeholder text
- “To be decided” sections
- Sloppy diagrams expecting later fixes

Why this fails

- Iteration 1 is graded as a complete analysis deliverable
- Later iterations build on this foundation

How to avoid

- Write Iteration 1 as if it will be reviewed by a client
- Assume all sections are final unless explicitly revised later

6. Poor Traceability and Consistency across Artifacts

What we often see

- Requirements not reflected in use cases
- Use cases not appearing in SSDs
- No clear mapping between artifacts

Why this fails

- Traceability and consistency are core learning objectives of this course

How to avoid

- **Cross-check:** Requirements → Use Cases → SSDs → Operation Contracts
- Use consistent naming and IDs

Final Reminder for Iteration 1

If Iteration 1 is weak, Iteration 2 and 3 will suffer. Strong teams invest time here and save effort later.

Iteration 1 success = Clear requirements + solid use cases + correct system boundary.